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Heilbronn 2027

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Visualisation: Parks and Green Spaces Office



01 Wellbeing Oasis at the Robert Mayer Monument

Redesign of the square around the Robert Mayer Monument
As part of a redesign, the area around the Robert Mayer Monument on Heilbronn's market square is being specifically upgraded and developed into an attractive place to spend time. As a central location in the city centre, the market square plays an important role for encounters, leisure and urban life.

The focus of the measure is the partial unsealing and restructuring of the area. New plantings of trees, shrubs and perennials create two green zones that enhance the urban space, provide shade and improve the microclimate. This is particularly relevant because Heilbronn is one of the cities with a high heat burden and is considered a heat hotspot in a nationwide comparison.

The design combines function and quality of stay: the borders of the planting beds also serve as seating and open up new views of the market square and the inner courtyard of the town hall. The result is a lively, green urban space that invites people to linger and strengthens the quality of the market square in the long term.

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The unsealing and new greenery noticeably reduce heat in the city centre and improve the microclimate on the market square. At the same time, the additional green structures create a more pleasant, climate-adapted space to spend time. The project thus contributes to a resilient, liveable city centre and sustainably increases the quality of stay.

General
The market square becomes noticeably more pleasant and attractive – for residents and visitors alike. New seating and an improved design create a lively place for meeting and spending time in the heart of the city. At the same time, there are positive impulses for inner-city life as well as for retail and gastronomy. The redesign is an example of how public space can be developed to be functional and attractive, sustainably strengthening Heilbronn's positive image.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: permanent

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €333,200

Coordination: Parks and Green Spaces Office

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Visualisation: Parks and Green Spaces Office





02 Mobile Greenery in the City Centre

More green. More life. More urban quality.
In 2027, temporary green experience spaces will be created at the main station, on Kiliansplatz, around the town hall, on the Friedrich-Ebert Bridge, at the theatre, at the Wollhaus, along the Allee and on other central squares. The aim is to visibly upgrade heavily sealed and overheated areas of the city centre and to show how a climate-adapted city can be designed through greenery and new places to spend time.

Mobile trees, shrubs and perennials as well as flexible street furniture, play and sports elements transform selected locations into attractive, usable feel-good zones. The spaces can be experienced in a new way and actively invite citizens to linger, meet and take part.

The special feature: after a certain time, the elements “wander” on to the next location. In this way, a single project can upgrade and test numerous places in the city centre one after another. At the same time, permanent improvements are deliberately left behind – for example through partial unsealing, new plantings or the upgrading of existing green spaces.

The project makes heat hotspots visible, initiates concrete climate adaptation measures and vividly shows what a liveable, green city centre of the future can look like.

- What is innovative about “Mobile Greenery” is that many places can be upgraded and tested one after another with comparatively few resources.
- “Mobile Greenery” shows what the city centre could look like in the future if adaptation to extreme weather is considered early on.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €1,219,800

Coordination: Parks and Green Spaces Office

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The project makes a direct contribution to climate adaptation in the city centre. Mobile greenery provides shade and cooling and noticeably reduces the burden of heat islands. Step by step, this creates climate-adapted urban spaces with a long-term effect. Materials and plants are reused beyond the project and integrated sustainably into the urban space, especially in the city districts.

General
In 2027 the city centre will become noticeably more pleasant and attractive – for citizens and visitors alike. At the same time, there are positive impulses for retail, gastronomy and inner-city life. The project shows how a future-proof, green city centre can be designed, sustainably strengthening Heilbronn's positive image.



Photo: City of Heilbronn/Häffner

03 Redesign of the Bleichinsel Bridge

More quality of stay on a central connection
The Bleichinsel Bridge is becoming far more than just a connection: it is developing into a central building block of a green and climate-adapted city centre. It links the Neckarbogen with Europaplatz and the Bildungscampus (education campus), while strengthening the connection between Campuspark and Neckaruferpark.

The previous temporary greenery in planters (the “little boats”) will be removed and replaced by permanent, extensive and low-maintenance planting. This creates robust green structures that promote biodiversity and improve the urban climate.

At the same time, traffic routing is being reorganised. Continuous cycle lanes reserved exclusively for cyclists will be created on the bridge in both directions, connecting to the existing cycle network. This makes the bridge an important part of safe and continuous cycling infrastructure in the city centre.

In addition, previously sealed and little-used areas will be greened and ecologically upgraded. The newly gained space will be used to noticeably increase the quality of stay and make the bridge more attractive for pedestrians. The result is a functional, climate-resilient and enjoyable urban space with a long-term impact.

- Flagship project for using bridges as green space and a visible strengthening of the inner-city Green Ring
- Model project for other cities, as promoting biodiversity and near-natural design are consistently placed at the centre

Facts & Figures

Project duration: permanent

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €621,700

Coordination: Parks and Green Spaces Office, Roads Office

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The previous temporary greenery is replaced by a permanent, extensive and low-maintenance design. This creates new green structures that strengthen biodiversity and improve the urban climate. Adjusting the traffic routing allows additional areas to be unsealed and greened. Previously unused areas are upgraded in a climate-adapted way. At the same time, a continuous green link is created between Campuspark and Neckaruferpark, connecting habitats and increasing the quality of stay.

General
The redesign of the Bleichinsel Bridge visibly upgrades a central urban space and creates an attractive place to spend time and meet. As the fastest connection between the main station and the education campus, it is of particular importance. It strengthens the link between the education campus, Neckarbogen and the city centre and makes the area more attractive for citizens, students and visitors – with an impact well beyond 2027.


Visualisation: Roads Office



Photo: City of Heilbronn

04 City Centre Cycling Ring

Safe and connected around the centre
A continuous cycling ring is being created around Heilbronn's city centre, connecting central locations and bringing a new quality to cycling. The route runs in a ring around the city centre and links important places into a clearly recognisable, coherent route.

The cycling ring combines existing, temporary and newly created infrastructure into one continuous connection. Uniform, eye-catching road markings provide orientation and make cycling more visible in the urban space.

The route runs mostly on the road, in some places separated from motor traffic. In individual sections such as Rollwagstraße and Gymnasiumstraße, the street space will be reallocated in favour of cycling.

This creates an attractive alternative to busy roads and an important building block for sustainable mobility in Heilbronn.

- Contribution to health, climate protection and the mobility transition, and convenient, continuous access to central places around the city centre
- Uniform signage and markings referring to the “European Green Capital” award, with high recognition value in the urban space

Facts & Figures

Project duration: permanent

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

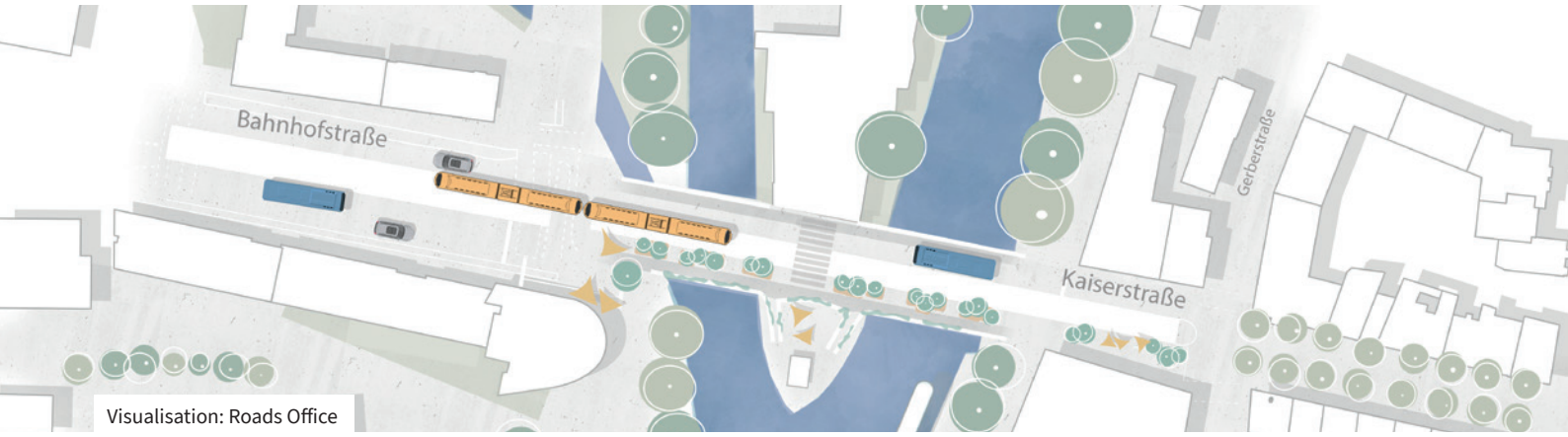
Budget: €635,000

Coordination: Roads Office

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The cycling ring strengthens cycling as an environmentally friendly form of mobility and helps reduce CO_2 emissions, air pollutants and noise. Cycling also needs much less street space, relieving pressure on the city centre. The clear routing and high visibility make cycling more attractive and promote it in the long term. The cycling ring is a model project and supports a lasting change in mobility behaviour – beyond 2027.

General
As public infrastructure, the cycling ring is available to all citizens and improves everyday mobility. A safe and clearly recognisable cycle connection particularly benefits vulnerable groups such as children and older people. At the same time, the cycling ring makes Heilbronn more attractive as a location: jobs, leisure facilities and the city centre become easier to reach. Cycling brings public space to life, encourages the use of shops and services and contributes to a lively city centre.



Visualisation: Roads Office

05 Traffic Trial on the Friedrich-Ebert Bridge

Temporarily rethought: mobility and urban space in transition
The Friedrich-Ebert Bridge is one of Heilbronn's central connecting axes between the city centre and the Bahnhofsvorstadt (station district), and at the same time a defining place with views of the experimenta, the Neckar promenade and the Neckar as a natural space.

In the European Green Capital year 2027, the bridge will be temporarily redesigned as part of a traffic trial. For a period of one to three months in summer 2027, the bridge will be closed to motor vehicles, while buses will continue to use the northern lane. During this time, the southern lane will be converted into a space to spend time, with seating and greenery.

A central aspect of the project is the noticeable relief for Gerberstraße: motor traffic there is expected to roughly halve, significantly improving the situation for residents and visitors to the city centre. This question has already been discussed many times in political committees and is now being put into concrete, visible practice with the traffic trial.

In addition, it is being examined whether bus traffic can be rerouted for one to three months in summer 2027, so that one lane can be converted into a space to spend time with seating and greenery during this period.

The project thus combines two goals: it provides important insights for future traffic planning and at the same time lets people experience how public space can change. On one of the city's most prominent axes, Heilbronn is implementing an innovative, highly visible measure that makes the transition to a sustainable and liveable city centre tangible.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 10 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €250,000

Coordination: Parks and Green Spaces Office, Roads Office

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The temporary redesign provides an impetus for sustainable mobility and invites people to try out alternatives to the car. During the project period, a noticeable reduction in noise and emissions in the city centre is expected. The elements used, such as greenery and furniture, are designed so that they can be reused and deployed throughout the city.

General
The traffic trial makes urban development directly tangible. Residents, pedestrians and cyclists in particular benefit from the reduction in motor traffic. At the same time, the project sends a strong signal beyond Heilbronn: as a trial in a complex traffic situation, it shows how central urban spaces can be reorganised. The insights gained are a model for other cities and give Heilbronn supra-regional appeal. It also creates impulses for gastronomy and retail, especially through the improved quality of stay and better experience of the urban space.



Design: Christian Held
Visualisation: visitor centre

06 Theatre as a Hub

A place for encounters and sustainable design
From summer 2026, a central hub for the European Green Capital 2027 will be created in Theater Heilbronn. The theatre plays a special role in the title year: as the venue for the official opening event and the award ceremony, it becomes the central hub and visible gateway to the European Green Capital, especially for international guests.

The theatre serves as a low-threshold entry point for citizens and guests. Central info points provide content and programmes of the European Green Capital as well as information about the theatre.

In addition to new information and ticket desks and a redesign of the café, the conversion includes a design upgrade of the façade. Sustainable LED elements and greening measures make the building more open and brighter from the outside and visible as a central point of contact in the urban space.

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The project combines structural upgrading with sustainable approaches. Energy-efficient LED elements and greening measures improve the building ecologically and make sustainability visible in the urban space. At the same time, the foyer is used to share knowledge and raise awareness of sustainability topics.

General
The entrance creates a new, central meeting place in the city centre and offers low-threshold access to the topics of the European Green Capital. By combining culture, information and places to spend time, the theatre is repositioned as an open place in the city. At the same time, the design upgrade makes the location more attractive and enlivens the city centre. The project is also a model, showing how cultural institutions can be used as a platform for urban development, participation and sustainability.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: permanent

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €103,200

Coordination: Theater Heilbronn, artistic director designate Solvejg Bauer


Photo: City of Heilbronn


Photo: Bill Shaylor

07 Urban Art

Grey silos become the city's canvases
In 2027, the silos of beweka Kraftfutterwerk GmbH on Hafenstraße in Heilbronn will become a large-format canvas for contemporary urban art. An internationally renowned artist will create an abstract design on the widely visible south side. Industrial architecture is reinterpreted and a striking visual landmark is created in the urban space.

Combining art and industry creates a new landmark with great appeal. The extraordinary dimensions of the surface – especially its height, size and curvature – make the project something special even internationally. Only a few artists worldwide have the experience to realise such formats.

The artwork will not only shape the cityscape but also give new impetus to how Heilbronn is perceived as a creative and innovative location. It invites people to rediscover the urban space and creates a destination for visitors, photography and urban culture.

It is being realised in close cooperation with beweka Kraftfutterwerk GmbH and experienced project partners. In future, further artistic designs could follow in the urban space and anchor urban art in the city in the long term.

- New, widely visible landmark with strong appeal for residents and visitors
- Pilot project with international reach and potential for further urban art projects in the city

Facts & Figures

Project duration: permanent

Planned period
within 2027: from July

Budget: €100,000

Coordination: Office for Schools, Culture and Sport

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The project sets an example for the resource-saving use of existing buildings. Instead of building on new land or replacing buildings, an existing industrial building is upgraded through design and integrated into the cityscape. The artistic transformation makes the existing structure visible and keeps it in long-term use. This is a future-proof contribution to urban development that requires no additional land and sensibly develops existing structures.

General
The project strengthens Heilbronn's image as a creative and cosmopolitan city and creates a new, widely visible landmark with supra-regional appeal. At the same time, it creates an attractive place for citizens and visitors that invites them to explore, linger and take photos. The upgrading of the urban space will have an effect well beyond 2027 and benefit the urban community in the long term.



Photo: City of Heilbronn

08 Transformation of the Vineyards

Experiencing a cultural landscape in transition
Wine growing has shaped Heilbronn for centuries and is a central part of the city's identity. As the oldest wine town in Württemberg, Heilbronn today faces the challenge of actively shaping the profound change in viticulture. Therein lies a great opportunity: Heilbronn can position itself as a pioneer and show new paths for a future-proof wine culture – with an impact far beyond the region. The focus is on three concrete measures that not only support the change professionally but above all make it visible and tangible for the public:

European Symposium 2027
An international expert meeting brings together experts, municipalities and science and makes Heilbronn the central place for exchange on the future of viticulture. The results feed directly into urban development and strengthen Heilbronn's role as a source of new ideas.

Living labs in the vineyards
New approaches such as biodiversity-friendly viticulture, alternative crops and innovative forms of land use are tested in practice on selected plots. Citizens can experience these developments on site and see how the vineyards are changing and evolving.

Vineyard discovery trail
A new discovery trail makes the transformation of the vineyards directly accessible. Information, guided tours and hands-on formats share knowledge and create an attractive space for local recreation and education.

- Focus on the “Weinbergarena” as a highly visible part of Heilbronn's wine-growing landscape
- Vineyard discovery trail in the southern part of the Weinbergarena (near Gaffenberg), linked to existing alternative forms of use
- Living labs, flowering areas and discovery trail open all year round; implementation starts in autumn 2026
- European Symposium at Heilbronn University in summer 2027

Facts & Figures

Project duration: permanent

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €178,500

Coordination: Parks and Green Spaces Office

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The project strengthens the ecological quality of Heilbronn's vineyards and develops them into diverse habitats for plants and animals. Targeted measures increase biodiversity and sustainably enhance the cultural landscape. At the same time, new, sustainable forms of cultivation are being tested. In addition, alternative crops are introduced that make viticulture more robust and climate-adapted in the long term.

General
The project lets people experience Heilbronn's vineyards anew as a space for nature, experiences and recreation, and strengthens the population's connection to their cultural landscape. Participation offers, educational formats and new places to explore actively involve citizens and raise awareness of the changes in viticulture. At the same time, it creates impulses for tourism, the regional economy and science. The exchange between the urban community, research and viticulture opens up new perspectives and strengthens Heilbronn's profile as an innovative centre of wine and knowledge.


Visualisation: City of Heilbronn


Photos: Pexels



09 Staging the Turmstraße Construction Site

Understanding, shaping and experiencing transformation
With the redesign of Turmstraße and Zehentgasse, a central area of Heilbronn's city centre will be fundamentally rethought from 2027. The aim is to create more greenery, more places to spend time and less traffic, and to develop the streets into climate-adapted, lively urban axes. The two streets will be built at different times: the conversion of Turmstraße starts in spring 2027, while Zehentgasse follows after around 1.5 years of construction.

Citizen participation has already played a central role in the planning process so far. Ideas, feedback and needs from the urban community have been incorporated into the planning and shape the future design of the urban space.

In the European Green Capital year, the construction site is therefore deliberately staged not just as a building project but as a space for experience and participation. Turmstraße becomes a “model construction site” for sustainable urban redevelopment, making transformation in everyday life visible and understandable.

The aim is to consistently continue this idea of participation: citizens should not only be informed but actively involved. How does a city change? What does climate adaptation concretely mean on your own doorstep? Temporary installations, information points and hands-on formats turn the construction site into a place for learning, discovering and co-creating.

Possible formats along the construction site will include:

- Construction site tours and “transformation tours” for all age groups
- Hands-on activities such as temporary greening or planting campaigns
- On-site visualisations (“before and after”, models, digital applications)
- Activities for children such as discovery trails or playful learning formats
- Dialogue formats with planners, administration and citizens

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 9 months

Planned period
within 2027: March to December

Budget: part of the budget of fact sheet 29

Coordination: Department of Strategy and Future Affairs

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
Staging the construction site makes climate adaptation and sustainable urban development directly visible. Topics such as unsealing, greening, water storage and heat reduction are explained and made tangible on site. At the same time, the staging helps build understanding for these measures and encourages sustainable behaviour in everyday life.

General
The construction site becomes a place for encounter and participation. Citizens experience transformation not in the abstract but concretely in their own surroundings. The project increases acceptance of changes in public space and promotes dialogue between the city, planners and the public. At the same time, the city centre is enlivened and staged in a new way during the construction phase. Heilbronn thus shows how urban redevelopment can be transparent, participatory and tangible.

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Visualisation: HMG





10 Water Show at Lake Hagenbuchersee

Laser and light show with a cultural programme in the heart of the city
With the “Water Show on Lake Hagenbuchersee”, an impressive stage will be created in the heart of the city from June to October 2027. A multimedia water show transforms the lake and the area around Untere Neckarstraße into a lively, interactive and central place of experience. The project combines a state-of-the-art water installation with vertical fountains, a hydro shield as a projection medium and precise video mapping on the façade of the experimenta. The show is complemented by a choreographed laser and light show and an integrated sound system. It combines impressive entertainment with educational content and makes central environmental and sustainability topics an emotional experience for a broad audience.

The particular strength of the project lies in the precise combination of these elements: water, projection and architecture interlock and create a three-dimensional depth that goes far beyond classic water features.

The project builds on the successful water show of the 2019 Federal Garden Show (BUGA) and develops it further in a new public space in the city centre. The show combines water and light and makes Heilbronn's identity as an innovative city on the river an emotional experience.

The combination of light art and water technology increases the attractiveness of the city centre and, in the context of the European Green Capital 2027, vividly conveys central topics such as the responsible use of resources to a broad audience.

During the water show at Lake Hagenbuchersee, a stage for local artists from Thursday to Saturday will also create a lively meeting place that combines culture, community and special experiences in a unique atmosphere.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 4 months

Planned period
within 2027: June to October

Budget:
Water show: €480,000
Stage: €120,000
Curating staff position
for the stage: €70,000

Coordination: HMG, Office for Schools, Culture and Sport

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The project conveys climate protection and sustainable use of resources in a vivid and understandable way. By combining technology, water and light, complex content becomes an emotional experience and contributes to raising awareness. As a freely accessible offer, the show reaches the entire population, raises awareness of sustainability in everyday life in a low-threshold way and thus supports sustainable urban development in the long term.

General
Based on comparable formats, the water show is expected to be a major crowd-puller with around 500,000 visitors, significantly boosting Heilbronn's tourist appeal. At the same time, it will give noticeable impetus to gastronomy and hotels. As a shared experience in public space, the show creates an attractive meeting place and strengthens residents' identification with their city.

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Photos: HMG



11 Light Art Festival

LiKuHN – Light · Art · Heilbronn
The Heilbronn Light Art Festival is an innovative ten-day cultural format that combines art, technology and sustainability in public space and lets people experience the city centre in a new way. On around ten event days in February – deliberately at the start of the title year and outside the classic holiday season – 15 to 20 light art installations will be realised at prominent locations in the city.

A curated route leads visitors through the city centre – from the Bahnhofsvorstadt via the education campus and the Neckarbogen to the Stadtgarten and the pedestrian zones. The roughly three-hour route combines art, urban space and encounters into one coherent experience. More than 100,000 guests are expected in total.

The festival builds on the great response to the 2019 Federal Garden Show and existing light formats and develops them further. At the same time, key future topics such as energy, conserving resources and sustainable urban development are conveyed creatively and vividly. This creates low-threshold access to complex content and a cultural highlight with great appeal.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 10 days

Planned period
within 2027: mid-February

Budget: €650,000

Coordination: HMG, Office for Schools, Culture and Sport

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The festival combines artistic innovation with a clear commitment to sustainability. Energy-efficient LED technology, smart control systems and green electricity ensure resource-saving implementation. In terms of content, the installations address topics such as energy, conserving resources and sustainable urban development. Creative formats such as upcycling installations help raise awareness. In addition, cooperation with international festivals means installations are reused several times and developed further.

General
The festival strengthens Heilbronn's profile as an innovative cultural location and, with more than 100,000 expected visitors, attracts additional guests to the city. Gastronomy, retail and hotels benefit. At the same time, it creates new meeting places in public space and promotes identification, participation and a lively city centre – with the potential to become a permanent festival format.



Visualisation: Office for Schools, Culture and Sport



12 Festival of Cultures

Celebrating together. Experiencing diversity.
In 2027, the “Festival of Cultures” will be a new, open and intercultural cultural format in the heart of Heilbronn that makes the diversity of the city visible and tangible. On two stages at Kiliansplatz and in the Deutschhof, international music, local players and different cultural perspectives come together to create a shared experience in public space.

A “Market of Possibilities” complements the programme, combining food, art and information. Heilbronn's international associations, organisations and initiatives actively shape the festival – with their own contributions on stage and with market stalls. Free admission allows everyone to take part.

The concept is currently being developed by the Office for Schools, Culture and Sport in close cooperation with the integration officers, HMG and interested migrant organisations. The festival offers low-threshold access to culture, promotes encounter and exchange and strengthens cohesion in the urban community.

At the same time, the festival takes up central themes of the European Green Capital and makes sustainable lifestyles tangible in a cultural context. Aspects such as sustainable food, fair consumption and global responsibility are conveyed in a low-threshold way and linked to the diverse perspectives of the urban community. The format thus combines cultural experience with raising awareness of ecological and social sustainability in everyday life.

In future, the festival is planned to continue every two years. The budget is based on comparable formats and amounts to around €100,000 to €120,000; additional funding is being applied for.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 2 days

Planned period
within 2027: summer

Budget: €100,000

Coordination: Office for Schools, Culture and Sport, integration officers, HMG and local associations

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The project makes an important contribution to social sustainability in Heilbronn by activating associations and organisations and involving them more strongly in city life. At the same time, it promotes networking between them and strengthens structures that are sustainable in the long term. Intercultural exchange strengthens understanding and cohesion within the urban community. The diversity of the city becomes visible and a positive experience, fostering open and respectful coexistence.

General
The festival enlivens the city centre and creates attractive new places to spend time and meet. At the same time, Heilbronn presents itself as a cosmopolitan and culturally diverse city. With international world music acts that rarely perform in the region, the festival also attracts visitors from further afield and sustainably strengthens tourism and the city's profile.

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13 Neckar Nature Games

The Neckar as a space for exercise and experience
With the “Neckar Nature Games”, Heilbronn is developing a new format for exercise and nature experience that lets people rediscover the Neckar area as a central part of the city. Under the guiding principle “connecting nature and exercise”, a continuous landscape for sport, leisure and encounters is created along the Neckar – from Wertwiesenpark to Lake Hagenbuchersee. On two consecutive days, both established and previously little-used areas such as Götzenturmpark and the adjacent riverbanks are activated and integrated into the concept. This makes the Neckar area visible as a versatile place for exercise and spending time.

The first day is dedicated to sporting competitions on and by the water, with disciplines such as canoeing, stand-up paddling, rowing and swimming open to both beginners and ambitious amateur athletes. On the second day, the format opens up to the whole urban community: clubs and organisations offer hands-on stations, taster sessions and exercise formats, complemented by environmental education.

An accompanying programme with a stage, music and regional food ensures a pleasant atmosphere and creates a lively, festival-like experience in public space.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: one weekend

Planned period
within 2027: summer

Budget: €60,000

Coordination: Office for Schools, Culture and Sport

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The Neckar Nature Games raise awareness of the Neckar as an ecologically valuable habitat and make sustainability topics tangible through exercise and environmental education. Sustainable event standards such as reusable systems, regional catering and conscious use of resources make sustainability visible. As the first format of its kind, they combine sport, nature experience and environmental education along the Neckar. Activating previously little-used areas and combining competition, hands-on activities and education creates an innovative approach with model character.

General
The Neckar Nature Games create an open, low-threshold offer for all age groups. Involving clubs and initiatives creates new partnerships and a stronger identification with the Neckar area. At the same time, the Neckar is activated as a space for exercise and experience. As a testing ground, the format provides impetus for a stronger, long-term integration into city life and sustainably increases the attractiveness of the Neckar.


Photo: Freepik


Photo: Freepik | DC Studio


Photo: Freepik

14 Heilbronn Sports Exchange

Swap. Repair. Reuse.
The “Heilbronn Sports Exchange” is a new event format that combines sport, sustainability and the circular economy in this form for the first time. At its heart is an open marketplace where used sporting goods, sportswear and equipment can be swapped, passed on or bought cheaply.

At a central location – for example the leisure meadow at the Frankenstadion – a low-threshold meeting place for citizens, clubs and initiatives will be created. The offer is complemented by a “Repair & Upcycling Corner”, where sports equipment can be repaired or upgraded on site, and by other hands-on formats.

The combination of flea market, repair services and interactive elements makes sustainability directly tangible and shows concrete options for action in everyday life. At the same time, the project strengthens networking between citizens, clubs and local businesses.

A first pilot on a smaller scale is already planned for 2026, for example as part of an evening market in cooperation with HMG.

As an innovative format with model character, the Sports Exchange also has the potential to be transferred to other cities or topics.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: one day

Planned period
within 2027: spring/summer

Budget: €30,000

Coordination: Office for Schools, Culture and Sport

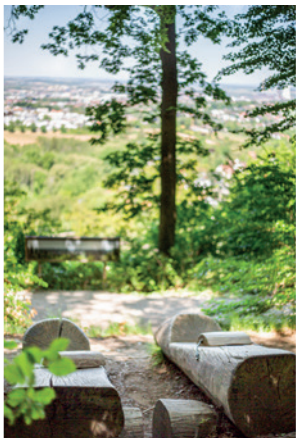
Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The Sports Exchange contributes directly to waste prevention and conserving resources by reusing, repairing and upgrading sporting goods. This extends their lifespan and actively promotes sustainable consumption. The event itself is also run in a resource-saving way, for example with reusable systems, waste separation and conscious use of materials.

General
The Sports Exchange creates a low-threshold offer for all age groups and promotes encounters, exchange and active participation in public space. Involving clubs and local businesses creates new partnerships. Craft and service businesses in particular gain a platform to present themselves. The innovative format strengthens Heilbronn's profile as a sustainable, sports-minded city and provides impetus for the leisure sector. In future, the Sports Exchange could also become an annual fixture in the city's events calendar.



Photos: City of Heilbronn





15 Heilbronn City Forest

Heilbronn's forest as a space for learning and experience
As the “green frame” of the city, Heilbronn's city forest is a central natural and recreational area. In 2027, a varied programme of events will put this space in the spotlight and make it even more tangible for the public. The offers combine environmental education, recreation and active participation and are run jointly by the Forestry Department, partners and volunteers.

A particular focus is on conveying ecological relationships and the importance of the forest for the climate, biodiversity and quality of life. At the same time, there are many opportunities to actively experience and help shape the city forest.

- 9th Heilbronn Forest Night (24 September) with around 20 stations in the eastern city forest and up to 1,200 visitors
- Cultural formats on the Waldheide such as poetry slam, jazz brunch and improv theatre (early summer to summer), each with up to 150 to 200 visitors
- Evening walks with foresters (spring to autumn, 3 to 5 dates, up to 30 participants each)
- Practical activities such as building ponds for water retention (autumn/winter), tree-planting campaigns (October/November, up to 500 participants) and Forest Cleanup Days (spring and autumn)
- Educational offers such as the school forest project with 50 to 60 sessions spread throughout the year
- Professional exchange through a conference of forestry offices with around 50 participants

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: municipal budget 2027/2028

Coordination: Forestry Department

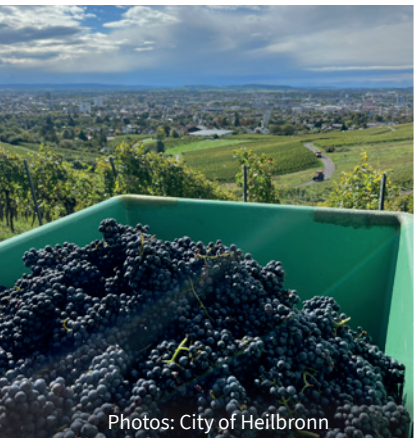
Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The project raises awareness of the importance of Heilbronn's city forest as a habitat, climate protector and recreational area. Ecological relationships are explained clearly and made tangible for different target groups. At the same time, it fosters identification with the city forest and strengthens long-term partnerships with schools, initiatives and volunteers, for example through the permanent school forest project.

General
The project combines nature, culture and education and makes the city forest tangible as a versatile space for experiences and encounters. It strengthens civic engagement and promotes cooperation with schools, initiatives and partners. At the same time, networking with the district is being expanded, especially through the WaldNetzWerk forest network. Formats such as the Forest Night also raise Heilbronn's profile. In addition, impetus is given to sustainable urban development, for example through sponge-city measures.

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16 Vineyards as a Place to Experience

Dinner in the vineyards, wine experience days
Heilbronn's vineyards are a defining part of the city and its identity. As the oldest wine town in Württemberg, they combine centuries-old tradition with a changing cultural landscape. From many points in the city there are views of the surrounding vine-covered slopes – a defining element of the cityscape that will be made even more tangible in future.

Events such as “Dinner in the Vineyards” or the wine experience days on the Wartberg deliberately open up the vineyards as a place to experience, and let locals and guests enjoy the combination of food and drink, landscape and regional culture. A first trial run of “Dinner in the Vineyards” is already planned for 2026.

At the same time, the formats take up current developments in viticulture and show how the cultural landscape is evolving in response to climate change and new requirements. This opens up new perspectives on the vineyards – as a place of encounter, regional value creation and shaping the future.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: permanent

Planned period
within 2027: summer

Budget: participant and stall fees plus €20,000

Coordination: HMG / wine industry / Weingut Fischer (dinner organiser)

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The events vividly illustrate how the vineyards are changing in the context of climate adaptation and sustainable agriculture. Topics such as climate-resistant grape varieties, new cultivation concepts or alternative crops – such as growing olives – are explained on site. This raises awareness of the challenges and opportunities in viticulture. At the same time, the cultural landscape is strengthened as an important part of biodiversity and sustainable land use.

General
The formats strengthen the connection between citizens, guests and regional producers and create new meeting places in the wine landscape. They promote the perception of the vineyards as a part of the city's identity and increase their attractiveness as a place for experiences and local recreation. At the same time, they create impetus for tourism and regional value creation. The events open up new economic perspectives for viticulture and position Heilbronn as a modern wine town with a future.

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17 Vegan Days

Street food, exhibition and infotainment for sustainable enjoyment
"Vegan Days" is a new event format in Heilbronn that focuses on responsible consumption and conscious eating. The three-day event takes place from 11 to 13 June 2027, parallel to the triathlon weekend, and uses the high footfall to reach a broad audience.

As a combination of trade fair, street food festival and information offer, around 50 exhibitors present a wide range – from vegan street food and food products to vegan cosmetics, clothing and information stands from public authorities, initiatives and NGOs.

This creates a lively space that combines enjoyment, information and exchange and makes sustainable lifestyles tangible. With at least 10,000 expected visitors, the event follows on from comparable formats and makes a visible contribution to Heilbronn's development as a sustainable and future-oriented city.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 3 days

Planned period within 2027: 11 to 13 June

Budget: €30,000

Coordination: HMG

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The Vegan Days promote more conscious consumption and show the impact of diet and lifestyle on the environment and climate. Plant-based eating helps reduce CO_2 emissions, resource consumption and land use, and this is explained clearly on site. By combining information with concrete offers, sustainable behaviour becomes tangible and practical for everyday life. The event thus helps raise awareness and supports more sustainable consumer behaviour.

General
The Vegan Days create an attractive event format that appeals to new target groups and enlivens the city centre. The link with the triathlon weekend brings additional visitor flows and impetus for gastronomy, retail and tourism. At the same time, Heilbronn positions itself as a modern, open and sustainable city that takes up current social issues and makes them tangible for citizens and guests.



Photos: City of Heilbronn/Häffner





18 Funding for the Independent Arts Scene

Strengthening creativity. Enabling diversity.
In 2027, Heilbronn's independent arts scene will become a key driver for bringing topics such as sustainability, climate protection and social change into the city creatively. Art and culture create access points that inform, move and invite people to take part – making the transformation process directly tangible for many people.

However, many players in the independent scene work under limited financial and structural conditions. Larger projects are often only possible with additional funding and a great deal of voluntary commitment. At the same time, the independent arts scene makes an important contribution to communicating the city's goals and programmes to society.

Festivals, performances, workshops and participatory formats actively involve the urban community and effectively complement the city's work. To unlock this potential, the city's project funding will be expanded, creating better conditions for professional, sustainable and widely accessible cultural projects.

- Increase in project funding by a total of €100,000: an extra €50,000 each for impulse funding (in addition to the existing budget of €70,000) and for funding music and singing, allowing more and larger projects to be realised
- Funding enables professional production, fair fees, sustainable event formats and broad social participation, for example through lower admission prices

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €100,000

Coordination: Office for Schools, Culture and Sport

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The funding enables cultural projects with a sustainability focus and at the same time strengthens regional players. Artistic formats address climate protection and ecological transformation and make these topics accessible to a broad audience. The project also makes an important contribution to social sustainability by promoting participation in art and culture and giving as many people as possible access.

General
The expanded funding enables a more diverse and broader cultural offer in Heilbronn and gives additional impetus to the city's cultural life. At the same time, the urban community is actively involved and encouraged to get more involved in city life and in shaping leisure activities.

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19 Annual Programme for Day-Care Centres

Early childhood education for a sustainable future
"How do we want to live today and tomorrow?" – this question is at the heart of the educational work in Heilbronn's day-care centres. It forms the basis for raising children's awareness of sustainable thinking and acting at an early age and giving them orientation for a future-proof way of life.

In a total of 115 facilities across the city – caring for around 6,000 children – this guiding question is addressed every day. Sustainability is not taught in the abstract but made concrete: through exercise, nature experiences, discovering things together and taking action themselves.

The facilities are already running numerous projects – from health and exercise programmes and waste separation to garden, forest and nature projects. Children also learn very practically how to get around in a climate-friendly way, for example by walking or cycling to nursery. Trips to the surrounding area, visits to the experimenta and researching and experimenting in everyday life also help to anchor environmental awareness early on.

Building on this experience, the commitment will be expanded. Education for sustainable development is firmly established and will be strengthened through new offers and partnerships, for example with the KLIMA ARENA. This creates a comprehensive educational offer that actively involves children and prepares them for the challenges of the future.

- City-wide implementation in all districts – reaches children regardless of origin and social background
- Concrete experiences instead of theory: including visits to the KLIMA ARENA, forest days, garden projects and tree-planting campaigns
- Strengthening partnerships between day-care centres, educational institutions and regional partners, and lasting integration into everyday life

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €25,000

Coordination: Office for Families, Youth and Senior Citizens

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The programme anchors sustainable thinking and acting in children's everyday lives at an early age. Topics such as conserving resources, climate protection and experiencing nature are taught playfully and internalised in the long term. Concrete measures such as garden and forest projects, waste separation or tree planting create a direct connection to the environment. This lays the foundation for sustainable behaviour that lasts beyond the nursery years.

General
The programme strengthens early childhood education in Heilbronn and reaches children from all parts of the city. It promotes equal opportunities, participation and a shared understanding of sustainable lifestyles. At the same time, families, facilities and partners become more closely connected. Heilbronn is thus deliberately investing in the next generation and laying the foundation for a future-proof, responsible urban community.






20 BildungsNetz Heilbronn (Education Network)

Central platform for sustainable educational offers
By further developing the central online database “BildungsNetz Heilbronn”, the city is strengthening educational offers for children and young people and making sustainability topics more accessible in everyday school life. Teachers and head teachers get a clear platform to easily find suitable out-of-school offers – from workshops and courses to action days – and integrate them directly.

In the year of the European Green Capital 2027 award, the platform plays a special role: schools can select and use offers and action days that teach sustainability and the environment in a practical way, some of which are also financially supported.

The focus is on offers in sustainability, cultural education, sport, STEM and media that open up new spaces for learning and experience for children and young people. Formats such as the “school forest” allow them to experience sustainability on site and help shape it.

Presenting all offers in one place provides clear orientation in the city's diverse educational landscape. At the same time, cooperation between schools and out-of-school partners is strengthened and more children and young people gain access to high-quality educational offers.

The project thus helps raise young people's awareness of future issues early on and promotes their active participation in the development of the city.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: online database set up from 2026; further development and optimisation in 2027

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €25,000

Coordination: Office for Schools, Culture and Sport

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The BildungsNetz specifically strengthens sustainable and nature-education offers for children and young people, for example through action days, school forest projects or explorer tours. Ecological topics are taught in a practical way and anchored in everyday life in the long term. Bundling everything digitally saves resources, as printing is no longer necessary and information can be updated efficiently. The project also has model character: the central, transparent overview of a diverse educational landscape is innovative and underlines Heilbronn's special position.

General
The BildungsNetz connects schools, pupils and numerous local institutions, strengthening Heilbronn's educational landscape. It provides easy access to a wide range of offers and enables broad participation. At the same time, the platform promotes cooperation with partners such as the city library, museum, city archive or out-of-school learning venues, and helps committed players make their offers visible and contribute them.

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21 Heilbronn Sustainability Pilots (NaLos)

Get active. Implement projects. Make an impact.
With the “Heilbronn Sustainability Pilots (NaLos)”, pupils actively shape a sustainable school. Young people from year 8 develop their own projects over the course of a school year and implement them independently at their school.

At the start, participants receive training in sustainability and project work. They develop initial project ideas, which they then implement with the support of project mentors and their own budget. The range of possible projects is wide: for example, waste-prevention concepts for the school, school gardens, energy-saving measures or campaigns for sustainable mobility.

The pupils take on responsibility, work in teams and experience first-hand how they can actively change their surroundings. At the end of the school year, they present their results in a competition between Heilbronn's schools.

The project strengthens young people's sense of responsibility and ability to act and anchors sustainable thinking directly in everyday school life. At the same time, the format can be flexibly integrated into existing lesson structures and thus reaches a broad target group within the schools.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: school year 2026/2027

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €15,000

Coordination: Office for Schools, Culture and Sport

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The Sustainability Pilots strengthen ecological development directly in everyday school life. The pupils' own projects lead to concrete improvements – for example in conserving resources, energy consumption, mobility or waste prevention. Sustainability is not only taught but actively put into practice. The projects continue to have an effect in the schools in the long term and help establish a lived culture of sustainability. At the same time, they provide practical access to environmental and climate topics that goes beyond lessons and anchors sustainable action in everyday life.

General
The Sustainability Pilots strengthen the participation of young people and promote personal responsibility, teamwork and social engagement. Pupils are actively involved in shaping their school and experience self-efficacy. At the same time, schools and the urban community benefit from new impetus and a stronger culture of sustainability.

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Photos: City of Heilbronn





22 Activities in the Cultural Institutions

Culture makes sustainability tangible
The cultural institutions of the City of Heilbronn make a central contribution to communicating sustainability and social change. With their wealth of knowledge, artistic forms of expression and many years of experience in education and outreach, they create many ways in for the urban community. They translate complex topics such as climate, resources or transformation into exhibitions, events and creative formats – making them tangible for all age groups.

In the **Municipal Museums**, sustainability is conveyed, for example, through the interactive exhibition “H2Oho! Heilbronn discovers water” (30 July 2026 to 14 March 2027) in the Museum im Deutschhof. The exhibition links global questions about water as the basis of life with local perspectives and actively involves groups from the urban community, such as water sports clubs. In addition, event series on air, water and climate are planned, aimed specifically at children and families.

The **City Library** creates low-threshold access to sustainability for all generations. Formats such as the “Human Library – people tell stories of sustainability” allow direct exchange with “living books” who share personal perspectives on sustainable action. The “Green Island” will be a permanently visible themed area with curated media. The offer is complemented by upcycling workshops for children, young people and adults as well as innovative elements such as an electricity-generating exercise bike that combines exercise, learning and energy generation.

The **Municipal Music School** sends a strong signal for creative engagement with future topics with the composition competition “Ad libitum” (funding volume €18,000). The best works will be performed in Heilbronn and at the renowned Eclat Festival in Stuttgart, making sustainability an artistic experience.

The **City Archive** contributes historical perspectives and uses exhibitions and dramatised tours to show how the environment, urban development and climate adaptation in Heilbronn have changed over time. This makes it clear that transformation is a continuous process.

The **Literaturhaus** dedicates its programme to nature writing and provides impetus with readings, discussions and writing projects. Plans include writing workshops in schools, a writing competition for young people aged around twelve to 16 and regular events every four to six weeks. The programme is complemented by an international conference and other literary formats.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months
Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €150,000
Coordination: Office for Schools, Culture and Sport

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The cultural institutions make sustainability clear and tangible for the public – through exhibitions, events and creative formats. Topics such as water, climate, resources or sustainable consumption are presented in an understandable and emotional way. Interactive offers, workshops and artistic engagement create low-threshold access to complex environmental issues. This raises awareness and anchors sustainable thinking in everyday life in the long term.

General
The programme strengthens cultural education in Heilbronn and reaches people of all ages – from children and young people to adults. It creates many opportunities to take part and actively invites the public to think along, help shape things and exchange ideas. At the same time, it strengthens the role of the cultural institutions as central places for education, encounter and social dialogue. Heilbronn thus positions itself as an open, creative and future-oriented city where sustainability is lived and shaped together.


Photo: Freepik | yanalya


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23 Programme in the Neighbourhood Centres

Experiencing sustainability in Heilbronn's districts
Heilbronn's neighbourhood centres are central places for meeting, exchange and support for people in the districts. They bring citizens together, promote volunteering and strengthen cooperation with associations and local network partners. In doing so, they make an important contribution to social cohesion in Heilbronn.

In 2027, the neighbourhood centres will be used specifically to make sustainable lifestyles visible and tangible in everyday life. Offers close to home reach people directly where they live and enable broad participation. The focus is not only on sharing knowledge but above all on practical action: how can each individual act more sustainably in everyday life?

In cooperation with the Heilbronn adult education centre (Volkshochschule), the educational offer will deliberately take place in the neighbourhoods. Instead of central events, outreach education reaches people where they live. Topics such as sustainable food, consumption or mobility are taught in a concrete, everyday way – for example through practical offers such as bike repair workshops.

The annual programme includes, among other things:

- Holiday programmes with neighbourhood-based activities, e.g. hikes
- Development of neighbourhood gardens at various locations
- Activities for young people in the small climate forest at the Wollhaus
- Plant swap markets, e.g. at the Böckingen neighbourhood centre
- Workshops in cooperation with vhs Heilbronn, including on responsible consumption and mobility

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €3,000

Coordination: Office for Families, Youth and Senior Citizens, vhs Heilbronn (adult education centre)

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The neighbourhood centres promote sustainable behaviour directly in people's everyday lives. Practical offers such as neighbourhood gardens, plant swaps or repair workshops make topics such as conserving resources, sustainable food and climate-friendly mobility tangible. Neighbourhood gardens also contribute to greening, biodiversity and a better microclimate. The focus is on low-threshold, everyday solutions that are actively practised and anchored in daily life in the long term.

General
The programme strengthens the neighbourhood centres as important meeting places and activates the urban community to help shape things. Citizens are motivated to get involved in their own neighbourhood. At the same time, the decentralised approach reaches people who often do not use traditional educational offers. This creates a broad, inclusive offer for all age groups.

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24 Citizens' Budget

Supporting sustainable ideas from the urban community
With the Citizens' Budget, Heilbronn is creating an open funding instrument that strengthens civic engagement for the environment and sustainability and carries it directly into the urban community. Citizens, associations and non-profit organisations have the opportunity to contribute their own project ideas and actively help develop a more environmentally friendly and liveable city.

With the Citizens' Budget, the City of Heilbronn is following the example of other European Green Capitals such as Essen and Guimarães, which have successfully implemented comparable participation formats, and is transferring these approaches to the local context.

The format is deliberately open and leaves room for a wide range of approaches – from small measures in the immediate neighbourhood to larger community projects. Whether unsealing surfaces, sustainable event formats or new ideas for more environmental awareness in everyday life: the variety of projects reflects the different perspectives and needs of the urban community.

In the 2027 funding year, up to 50 projects in total will be supported in two application rounds (Q1 and Q3). In each round, around 25 projects can receive up to €1,000 each. After a successful application, funding is provided by the climate foundation of Kreissparkasse Heilbronn. Projects are selected by the Climate Protection and Sustainability Advisory Board on the basis of clearly defined ecological, social and economic sustainability criteria.

At the same time, the Citizens' Budget strengthens personal responsibility and identification with the city: citizens themselves become agents of change and actively shape their surroundings. Selected projects are made publicly visible and carry their impact into the urban community – as concrete examples of sustainability in practice.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €50,000

Coordination: Department of Strategy and Future Affairs

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The Citizens' Budget enables concrete environmental measures that come directly from the urban community. Many small, decentralised projects lead to visible improvements in everyday life – in neighbourhoods, communities and associations. The open format encourages a wide range of approaches to environmental and climate protection and strengthens sustainable development from the bottom up. At the same time, successful projects can serve as role models and inspire further initiatives.

General
The Citizens' Budget strengthens participation by the urban community and makes citizens active co-designers of urban development. People can implement their own ideas independently, which promotes identification, a sense of responsibility and collective action. At the same time, new partnerships emerge between citizens, associations and the administration. Step by step, this builds a network of committed people who initiate and sustain local sustainable projects.


Photo: City of Heilbronn


Photo: Pexels


Photo: Pexels

25 Activation and Participation Offers

Civic engagement for climate protection and quality of life
In Heilbronn, sustainability has for many years not only been planned but lived together. The participation offers invite citizens to become active themselves and help shape the city's development in concrete ways.

The focus is on simple, low-threshold formats that show: every contribution counts. Whether in everyday life, in a club, in a company or together with others – participation is deliberately designed to reach as many people as possible.

The main existing offers include:

- City Cycling (Stadtradeln): every summer, over 21 days, with more than 2,000 participants who collect cycling kilometres together and thus actively contribute to climate protection
- Greening competition: first held in 2026, continued in 2027 with around 20 participants who unseal and green private areas; supported by €5,000 in prize money from the Kreissparkasse climate foundation
- Tree sponsorships and tree donations: permanent participation formats at no additional cost, with the goal of more than 50 new tree sponsors who actively help green and care for the city's trees
- Further campaigns and competitions that promote individual and community engagement

A special highlight is the Sustainability and Mobility Day on 18 September 2027, when the results of the competitions will be publicly awarded. The day also offers a platform for associations, initiatives and organisations to present themselves, contribute their own offers and talk to citizens.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: municipal budget 2027/2028

Coordination: Department of Strategy and Future Affairs, Roads Office

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The participation offers start directly in people's everyday lives and enable concrete contributions to climate protection and climate adaptation – for example through sustainable mobility, greening or promoting urban green spaces. The many small measures add up to a measurable effect, especially in areas that the city administration can only influence indirectly, such as individual mobility behaviour or the design of private land.

General
The formats strengthen civic engagement and promote a sense of community in the city. They show that everyone can make a contribution – regardless of age, background or prior experience. At the same time, engagement is made visible and recognised, for example through public awards and events. This motivates further participation and strengthens identification with Heilbronn.

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Photos: City of Heilbronn





26 European Action Weeks

European Green Week, European Mobility Week, European Week for Waste Reduction
In the European Green Capital year, Heilbronn becomes part of a Europe-wide network for sustainable development – and makes this network tangible locally. By taking part in the European action weeks, the city's commitment is linked with initiatives and ideas from all over Europe.

The focus is on three established formats that are already anchored in Heilbronn today and will be expanded in the title year:

- European Green Week (June): local events on current environmental topics – from workshops and exhibitions to discussion formats – in close cooperation with universities, companies and initiatives
- European Mobility Week (September): activities around sustainable transport, with the Mobility and Sustainability Day as the central event (approx. 1,000 participants)
- European Week for Waste Reduction (November): concrete hands-on offers and campaigns that show how resources can be used consciously in everyday life

The action weeks bring European topics directly into the city – and at the same time put Heilbronn into a European context. They invite people to find out more, try things out and become active themselves.

What is special is the openness of the formats: citizens, companies, universities and initiatives can get involved and create their own contributions. This results in a lively programme supported by the urban community. Integration into European platforms and networks makes Heilbronn visible beyond the city limits.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 1 week each

Planned period
within 2027: June, September, November

Budget: €15,000

Coordination: All specialist offices

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The action weeks make central sustainability topics directly tangible – from climate-friendly mobility and conserving resources to environmental awareness in everyday life. Concrete campaigns and hands-on formats not only inform but encourage action. Sustainability is thus made tangible, practical and relevant to everyday life.

General
The European action weeks bring people together and create space for exchange, participation and learning together. They strengthen networking between local players and open up new perspectives through European exchange. At the same time, Heilbronn visibly positions itself in a European context. The city shows that it is part of a shared movement – and actively helps shape it.







27 Volunteer Management

A strong network for a lively sense of community
Volunteers are a key success factor for the European Green Capital year 2027 in Heilbronn. They make the programme visible, tangible and personal – as hosts, contact persons and ambassadors for their city. Volunteer management specifically activates Heilbronn residents to volunteer in the title year. They support events and exhibitions, welcome visitors, accompany programmes and are the first point of contact for questions. In this way, they decisively shape the atmosphere and perception of the entire year.

The programme runs under the name “Du machst Heilbronn.” (“You make Heilbronn.”), deliberately building on the campaign of the same name from 2024. It is designed as a further development and turns the culture of participation initiated there into a long-term volunteering format for the title year.

The importance of this engagement was shown by BUGA 2019: more than 150 volunteers contributed over 11,500 voluntary hours and, as ambassadors for the city, became a defining element of the entire event. Heilbronn is deliberately building on this experience and developing volunteering further as part of the European Green Capital.

Organisation takes place via the website heilbronn.now, supplemented by personal contact persons. All volunteers receive training before their assignment that prepares them for their tasks and gives them confidence in dealing with guests and content. Uniform identifying features make them visible and approachable in the urban space.

The volunteers take on a variety of roles:

- Contact persons for guests in the city
- Support at events and exhibitions
- Providing information and orientation
- Personal ambassadors for Heilbronn

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: part of the budget of 28 Staging the Urban Space

Coordination: Department of Strategy and Future Affairs

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
Volunteers make an important contribution to environmental education by communicating sustainability topics directly in personal conversation. They explain projects on site, provide orientation and create low-threshold access to complex content. This direct approach makes sustainability tangible and relevant to everyday life, often more effectively than traditional information formats.

General
The project strengthens civic engagement. Volunteers identify more strongly with Heilbronn and actively carry this positive attitude outward. At the same time, they improve the visitor experience, take pressure off event organisation and ensure a personal, open atmosphere. Heilbronn is thus perceived as a hospitable city. In the long term, an experienced pool of volunteers is created that can also be called on beyond 2027.



Photo: City of Heilbron



Photo: City of Essen



Photo: HMG



28 Staging the Urban Space

Making the European Green Capital visible throughout the cityscape
In the European Green Capital year, the whole of Heilbronn's urban space becomes a stage for sustainability. The aim is to make the award visible not just at individual points but in people's everyday lives – in all districts, on squares, in streets and in public buildings.

To this end, existing projects and places in the city are deliberately linked and staged. Whether along the cycling ring, in the neighbourhood centres, on the Neckar or at central construction sites such as Turmstraße – small and large impulses everywhere show how Heilbronn is changing.

This staging can take very different forms: temporary “green interventions” in public space (fact sheet 02), visible references to projects, or simple orientation elements such as floor markings and signposts that guide people through the city.

A uniform design ensures that the European Green Capital is present throughout the cityscape and that individual measures come together into an overall picture.

A particular focus is on reaching everyone in the city – regardless of age or prior knowledge. People encounter the topics naturally in everyday life: when shopping, on the way to work or when walking through their district. The administration builds on its experience of staging the urban space as part of “Heilbronn zeigt Geschmack” in summer 2022.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €250,000

Coordination: Department of Strategy and Future Affairs

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
Staging the urban space makes the European Green Capital directly visible and understandable in everyday life. Existing measures and projects are linked in the urban space and placed in a larger context. Simple, everyday formats create a better understanding of ecological relationships and sustainable action – without using additional land or requiring complex interventions.

General
Staging the urban space connects the whole city into a shared experience and creates low-threshold access for all population groups. It strengthens identification with the award and makes the many projects tangible as a coherent whole. At the same time, Heilbronn becomes visible as European Green Capital throughout the cityscape – not just at individual points, but permanently in people's everyday lives.



Photo: City of Essen

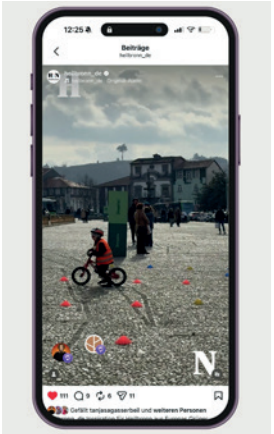



Photo: HMG

29 Information and Communication Measures

Creating visibility, conveying content and reaching people
The information and communication measures form the connecting foundation of the European Green Capital year and ensure that the many projects, initiatives and developments are visible, understandable and accessible to everyone.

The aim is to communicate the topics of sustainability, climate protection and urban development clearly, consistently and in an everyday way, and to actively involve the whole urban community. At the same time, the title year will be used to position Heilbronn more strongly as an attractive, liveable and innovative city – both internally and externally.

Experience from other European Green Capitals shows that the title year can have a lasting positive effect on a city's image and generate additional attention and rising visitor numbers. This opportunity is being seized deliberately: communication is therefore also aimed specifically at guests and professional visitors and helps put Heilbronn more firmly in the spotlight as a travel destination and event venue.

A particular focus is on presenting complex content in an understandable and vivid way and on linking individual projects into a clearly recognisable overall picture. The diversity of the city – from the city centre and the Neckar to the neighbourhoods – is conveyed as one connected space to experience.

Key building blocks are:

- Digital channels such as the website, social media and a central events calendar
- Traditional formats such as the city newspaper, official gazette and brochures for specific target groups
- Visible information and wayfinding systems in the urban space
- Storytelling about projects, places and people
- Accompanying communication for events and key highlights
- Measures to specifically address and guide guests

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €1,105,000

Coordination: Department of Strategy and Future Affairs, Communications

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The communication measures make an important contribution to conveying sustainability topics and raising public awareness. They make ecological relationships understandable and show concrete options for action in everyday life. Close links with real projects and places make sustainability practical and tangible. The targeted use of digital formats also supports resource-saving communication.

General
The information and communication measures create low-threshold access to all offers in the European Green Capital year and reach the entire urban community. They connect projects, places and players and make the overall programme visible as a coherent experience. At the same time, they strengthen the perception of Heilbronn at regional, national and European level. The increased visibility, additional visitors and new perspectives on the city provide impetus for tourism, city-centre development and economic momentum.

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Photos: City of Heilbronn



30 Congresses and Conferences in the Title Year

Heilbronn in the focus of the national and European expert community
Conferences and specialist meetings are a central pillar of the European Green Capital year 2027 in Heilbronn. As a European ambassador city, Heilbronn uses these formats to make experience, best practices and innovative approaches in sustainable urban development, environmental and climate protection accessible to a national and international professional audience.

The events create platforms for knowledge transfer, professional exchange and networking between politics, science, administration and practice. At the same time, they bring top-class experts to Heilbronn and strengthen the city's position as a location for innovation and future topics. Numerous conferences, specialist events and network meetings are planned or in preparation for 2027 – often in cooperation with renowned partner organisations and existing event formats:

Several high-level specialist congresses and conferences on key future topics such as mobility, energy, water, sustainable urban development, tourism and viticulture

- Mobility: including Cable Car Day, RadKONGRESS Baden-Württemberg (with around 500 professional participants as a reference format), POLIS Leadership Summit
- Energy: German Citizens' Energy Convention with talks, panels and workshops
- Water: Water Bodies Dialogue of the German Association for Water, Wastewater and Waste (DWA)
- Urban development: European Commission Cities Forum, Baden-Württemberg Timber Construction Days
- Viticulture: specialist conference “Future of the Vineyards” together with Heilbronn University and partners from practice and research
- Tourism & city marketing: Baden-Württemberg Tourism Day (TMBW), federal congress of the bcsd
- Additional expert meetings: sessions and working groups of the German Association of Cities and the Baden-Württemberg Association of Cities

Many of the formats are currently being coordinated or are in the application phase. Integrating established congresses increases supra-regional appeal and at the same time reduces the organisational effort.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

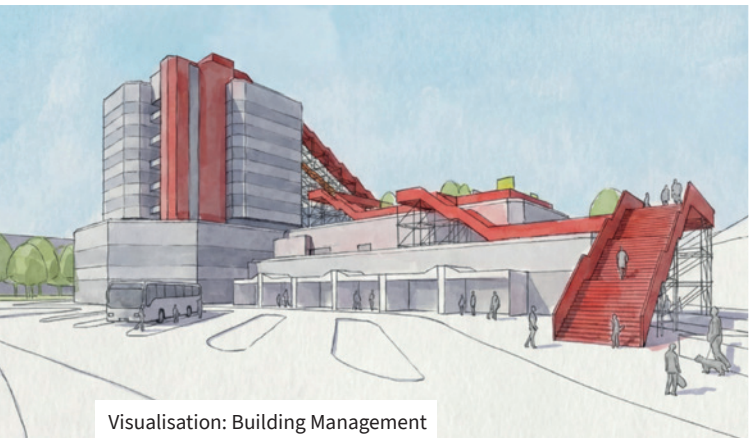
Budget: €323,500

Coordination: All specialist offices, HMG

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The conferences promote professional exchange on key climate, environmental and sustainability topics and thus make an important contribution to developing new solutions. Insights from science, practice and politics are pooled and passed on. At the same time, care is taken to run the events in a resource-saving way. Using existing formats, central venues and sustainable event standards – such as digital formats, reduced materials and encouraging travel by public transport – saves resources and minimises environmental impact.

General
The conferences bring together experts, the administration, local players and interested citizens and create space for exchange and networking. Some formats also allow public participation. At the same time, partnerships are formed with universities, institutions and associations. The events strengthen Heilbronn as an innovative and sustainable venue for conferences and congresses.



Visualisation: Building Management





31 Rooftop Walk at the Wollhaus

WOW-Haus: an experience for the whole city
One of the most-discussed places in the city becomes a place with real appeal: in 2027, Heilbronn's Wollhaus will be temporarily transformed into the WOW-Haus – a place to experience sustainable urban development that combines an exhibition with a walk-through urban experience.

A special element of the project is the collaboration with the internationally renowned Dutch architecture firm MVRDV. The firm has been working on the innovative use of unused roof areas for years and attracted attention across Europe with the spectacular Rooftop Walk in Rotterdam in 2022. The fact that Heilbronn was chosen as the location for a comparable project underlines the high relevance and appeal of the project and is also a special distinction for the city.

The central element is a Rooftop Walk that connects the exhibition on the ground floor (fact sheet 32) with interactive areas on the roofs of the building. For a period of about 4 to 6 weeks (May/June 2027), a walkable route will be created above the rooftops, inviting visitors to rediscover previously unused urban spaces. On the roofs, people can experience concretely what the ecological, social and urban transformation of Heilbronn could look like. Topics such as greening, water retention, energy generation and new public spaces and connections are presented vividly.

The Rooftop Walk thus becomes the “BIG WOW!” of the WOW-Haus – and an invitation to everyone to experience the city from a new perspective and actively think about Heilbronn's future.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 4 to 6 weeks

Planned period
within 2027: May/June

Budget: €900,000

Coordination: Building Management

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

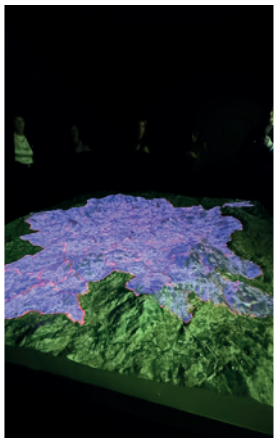
Environment and sustainability
The Rooftop Walk makes the potential of roof areas for sustainable urban development tangible – for example for greening, water retention, energy generation and new public spaces. This makes a previously little-used urban space visible. At the same time, the project itself is implemented in a resource-saving way. Central elements such as the scaffolding can be reused, plants will be replanted elsewhere and materials such as wood or textiles will be put to new uses.

General
The WOW-Haus reinterprets a prominent place in the city centre. Thanks to its central location, the Wollhaus receives new attention and temporarily becomes a place for encounter, exchange and urban development. The project appeals to different target groups – from citizens to international guests as well as students and researchers from the education campus and IPAI. At the same time, Heilbronn sends a clear signal for innovative urban development. Inspired by international examples such as the Rooftop Walk in Rotterdam, the project shows how unused spaces can be rethought.

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Photos: City of Heilbronn

32 Exhibition “Heilbronn – European Green Capital”

A place for ideas, dialogue and change
The exhibition “Heilbronn – European Green Capital” on the ground floor of the WOW-Haus is the central experience format and the most important point of contact for visitors in 2027. As an interactive and accessible exhibition, it makes Heilbronn's transformation into a sustainable city visible, understandable and tangible.

The exhibition combines information, interaction and participation in an open, low-threshold format. It is dynamic, with changing themes – for example every two months – and deliberately designed for repeat visits. The focus is on a variety of experience and hands-on formats: stations such as a “Model of the Future”, a “Map of Actions”, interactive podiums and a “Wall of Wishes” let visitors not only take in information but get actively involved and develop their own ideas. What is special is the combination of playful learning, real city projects and active participation. The exhibition is complemented by an accompanying programme of workshops, talks and collaborative formats in the integrated forum and workshop area.

An innovative element is its parallel use as the Retail Innovation Factory (IFH 2.0): here, Heilbronn founders can test and develop their business models under real conditions. This creates a central link between exhibition, participation and real-world application.

Thanks to its central location, the exhibition attracts many visitors while remaining easy to access. Funding and sponsorship from the state, the federal government and local partners are currently being examined.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 12 months

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: €700,000

Coordination: Department of Strategy and Future Affairs, Economic Development Unit

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The exhibition makes concrete measures for climate protection, the circular economy, energy and urban greening visible and understandable. Interactive formats actively involve visitors and encourage sustainable behaviour in everyday life. At the same time, attention is paid to resource-saving implementation: materials and structures are modular and can be reused at the end.

General
The exhibition is aimed at the entire urban community and creates many opportunities for active participation. Interactive formats, workshops and hands-on offers invite people to contribute their own ideas. At the same time, networks between the city, business and civil society are strengthened and local founders are visibly involved through IFH 2.0. The exhibition enlivens the city centre, increases footfall in the Wollhaus and acts as an activating interim use before the site is redeveloped from 2028. Insights from the exhibition and IFH 2.0 can feed into future use and provide long-term impetus for urban development.


Photos: Guimarães





33 Opening Ceremony

Heilbronn in the European spotlight of sustainable urban development
The opening event of the European Green Capital 2027 marks the ceremonial start of a special year for the City of Heilbronn. As a mandatory element of the title year, it brings together high-ranking representatives of the European Commission, delegations from European cities and many local players.

The central ceremony takes place in the Stadttheater Heilbronn and features speeches by the Lord Mayor and the European Commission. The musical and artistic programme by the theatre and the Württemberg Chamber Orchestra Heilbronn (WKO) creates a festive setting and symbolically opens the title year.

To involve the whole urban community, the event will be livestreamed to the market square. At the same time, a winter market will be held there where citizens can find out about local sustainability initiatives, talk to the people behind them and meet international guests – including representatives of former title cities such as Essen.

Another important item on the day of the opening ceremony is the official signing of the Green City Accord by new European cities. They join publicly during the event and underline their commitment with short contributions. This makes Heilbronn a central meeting point for European cities in sustainable urban development.

The programme is complemented by a networking format for the international delegations, which promotes exchange between cities and initiates long-term cooperation.

- Date: expected 15 January 2027
- Venue: Stadttheater Heilbronn (ceremony) and market square (livestream & winter market)

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 1 day

Planned period within 2027: 15 January

Budget: €218,000

Coordination: Theater Heilbronn, Department of Strategy and Future Affairs

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The opening ceremony sets the thematic tone for the year and makes environmental and climate protection topics visible. Through exchange with European cities, the European Commission and experts, current approaches and solutions are presented and passed on. At the same time, sustainability is also taken into account in the organisation – for example by using existing venues, digital formats such as livestreams and by encouraging broad, low-threshold participation.

General
The opening brings together international guests, experts and the urban community and makes Heilbronn the European centre of sustainable urban development. It strengthens the city's visibility at national and international level and creates attention well beyond the title year. Combining a festive opening in the theatre with a public programme on the market square enables broad participation. At the same time, new networks are formed that have a long-term impact on urban development.



Photos: HMG



34 Winter Market for the Opening

Experiencing Europe – together in Heilbronn
The winter market on Heilbronn's market square is a central part of the opening event of the European Green Capital 2027 and lets the whole urban community experience the start of the title year.

From 14 to 17 January 2027, the wintry market square will be transformed into a place of encounter and exchange. Up to twelve stalls, styled like those of the Christmas market, will be run by associations and groups from Heilbronn. They present Europe's cultural diversity through typical food and drinks, crafts, design, music and small cultural contributions.

The central element is a large LED screen that connects the market square with events across Europe. Here, the official opening event of the European Green Capital on 15 January 2027 will be broadcast live and made accessible to everyone. The programme is complemented by moderated talks, interviews and live links to partner cities and other European cities presenting their projects and initiatives.

The winter market thus combines local experience with a European perspective and creates an emotional, community-based start to the title year.

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The winter market creates low-threshold access to European sustainability topics and links them with cultural and social aspects. Presenting different initiatives and perspectives raises awareness of sustainable development in a European context.

General
The winter market enables broad participation by the urban community and brings together people from different cultures. Associations and initiatives get the opportunity to get actively involved and show their diversity. At the same time, the opening event becomes an experience in public space for several thousand visitors. Heilbronn presents itself as an open, diverse and European-connected city and creates a shared start to the title year.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: 4 days

Planned period
within 2027: 14 to 17 January

Budget: covered by fact sheet 33

Coordination: HMG

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Photos: European Commission





35 European Green Capital 2029 Award Ceremony

Heilbronn at the centre of the European sustainability movement
The European Green Capital 2029 award ceremony is one of the official highlights of the 2027 title year and a mandatory event of the European programme. It centres on the ceremonial award of the next European Green Capital and of two “Green Leaf” cities – an award for smaller cities that are particularly committed to sustainability.

The event is festive, formal and at the same time emotional. Three finalist cities for the title European Green Capital 2029 and four finalist cities for the European Green Leaf Award 2029 are expected to attend, having presented their concepts to the EU jury beforehand.

The award ceremony is accompanied by a programme lasting several days with presentations, specialist formats and networking opportunities. For several days, Heilbronn becomes the meeting point of the European sustainability scene.

Impressions from Vilnius (Lithuania) 2025: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Jri-ORnk37ng

Other components:

- Delegations from European cities and the EU
- Specialist presentations and jury processes beforehand
- Supporting programme with tours and exchange formats

Facts & Figures

Project duration:

Planned period
within 2027: 5 to 8 October

Budget: €162,000

Coordination: Department of Strategy and Future Affairs

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The award ceremony brings together current strategies and approaches to sustainable urban development from all over Europe. The exchange between cities promotes the further development of innovative solutions and strengthens cooperation at European level. The event follows sustainable event standards and makes efficient use of existing infrastructure.

General
The event brings international attention to Heilbronn and strengthens the city's visibility at European level. As host of a central EU format, Heilbronn positions itself as a connected, future-oriented city. At the same time, new contacts and partnerships are formed that will have an effect beyond 2027 and provide impetus for urban development, innovation and international cooperation.



Photos: City of Heilbronn





36 “Green Badge Heilbronn” for Businesses

Making sustainable engagement visible
The “Green Badge Heilbronn” creates a visible award system for businesses that are actively committed to environmental and climate protection. The aim is to make sustainable business visible in the cityscape and at the same time give other businesses an incentive to take concrete measures.

Businesses with direct customer contact can apply for a badge and are awarded according to the scope of their measures: a light green badge for meeting basic criteria such as waste separation or using green electricity, and a dark green badge for further achievements, for example in sustainable mobility or through existing sustainability labels.

The criteria are sector-specific and take into account the different requirements of gastronomy, retail, services and hotels. The concept was developed together with local players, in particular Stadtinitiative Heilbronn e. V., to ensure it is practical and widely applicable.

With the Green Badge, the City of Heilbronn builds on proven approaches of other European Green Capitals such as Valencia (Spain) and transfers successful models for promoting sustainable business to the local context.

Applications are made easily via an online procedure. This creates a low-threshold instrument that motivates businesses to expand their engagement and at the same time makes it transparent and visible to customers.

Facts & Figures

Project duration: permanent

Planned period
within 2027: starting autumn 2026

Budget: part of the budget of fact sheet 29

Coordination: Department of Strategy and Future Affairs

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
The “Green Badge” creates incentives for concrete environmental measures in everyday business – from saving energy to sustainable mobility. Its visibility in the cityscape means that sustainable practices are not only implemented but also communicated. At the same time, it raises customer awareness and encourages more conscious purchasing decisions. This creates a double effect: businesses act more sustainably while consumers specifically seek out sustainable offers.

General
The “Green Badge” makes sustainable engagement visible and provides orientation in everyday life. It links sustainability directly with local offers and increases transparency for citizens. As a low-threshold instrument, it activates broad participation by the local economy and fosters identification with Heilbronn as European Green Capital. In the long term, it will establish itself as a quality seal for sustainable business.



Photos: City of Heilbronn





37 Involving the City Districts

Making sustainability visible and tangible in all districts
Involving Heilbronn's districts is a central building block of the European Green Capital 2027. The aim is to make sustainability visible, tangible and effective not only in the city centre but across the entire city.

The project combines decentralised construction and infrastructure measures, district-based communication and participation formats, and broad offers for all citizens.

A key element is concrete construction projects in the districts that anchor sustainability permanently. These include:

- Neckartalschule Böckingen – climate-neutral operation with 100 percent renewable energy
- Kreuzgrund day-care centre (Böckingen), Lotte Lemke day-care centre (Horkheim)
- Bahnbogen Süd (Böckingen)
- Northern bypass (Frankenbach)
- Hammelsberg solar park (Biberach)
- Stöckach wind farm (Kirchhausen)

These projects are examples of how climate protection, energy supply, infrastructure and urban development are being implemented directly in the districts.

Visibility and communication in the districts
The European Green Capital is deliberately brought into the districts and actively communicated there:

- Presence at district festivals with information and activity stands
- Integration into the staging of the urban space (fact sheet no. 28)
- Separate category in the events calendar for offers in the districts

This ensures that all districts are actively involved and that the projects are noticed in citizens' immediate surroundings.

Transferring city-centre projects to the districts
A particular focus is on the sustainable reuse of measures from the city centre:

- Mobile greenery and street furniture from the Wollhaus will be used in the districts in the long term
- Elements of “Mobile Greenery” will be transferred to the neighbourhoods

Added value for the City of Heilbronn

Environment and sustainability
City-wide implementation strengthens climate protection and climate adaptation across the whole city. Unsealing, greening and renewable energies bring concrete ecological improvements directly on site. At the same time, everyday offers promote sustainable behaviour in the long term.

General
The project strengthens social cohesion, as all districts are actively involved. Citizens experience the European Green Capital not only centrally but in their own surroundings. The combination of infrastructure, participation and communication ensures broad identification and a lasting impact beyond 2027.



Photos: City of Heilbronn





37 Involving the City Districts

- City-centre measures thus have a lasting effect across the whole city

This creates sustainable added value beyond 2027.

Highlight: unsealing in all districts
A central participation element is a joint, visible project in all districts:

- Each district designates an area of approx. 10 m² to be unsealed (e.g. a parking space)
- Furnished with a lounger bench and perennial planting
- Creation of small, decentralised green places to spend time

This format combines climate adaptation, quality of stay and local identity and makes transformation visible on the spot.

Decentralised offers for all citizens
Many of the programmes are aimed specifically at the districts and reach people in their everyday lives:

- Educational programmes in day-care centres (fact sheet no. 19) – across all districts
- Citizens' Budget (no. 24) – funding for small projects in the immediate neighbourhood
- Activation and participation offers (no. 25) – e.g. greening private land or City Cycling
- Programmes in neighbourhood centres (no. 23) – education and participation offers close to home

Facts & Figures

Project duration: permanent

Planned period
within 2027: January to December

Budget: included proportionally in existing projects

Coordination: Department of Strategy and Future Affairs in cooperation with the specialist offices